

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

Rude Emails

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 20

No.	Sentence
1	Email is common in modern workplaces, and most people try to make their messages sound _____.
2	One listener dislikes emails that begin with only a name and no simple _____.
3	This unnecessary formality can make the reader feel immediately _____.
4	Another example of rude email behaviour was replying to a careful message with a single _____.
5	Such rude email behaviour is described as _____.
6	A fight response may involve dominance or _____ of other people.
7	One hostile email tactic is copying in _____ to escalate the issue.
8	By contrast, a flight response involves self-protection through _____ or avoidance.
9	To get something "off your plate" means moving a task away from your own _____.
10	People are more likely to be uncivil when they are _____.

11 **What workplace issue is introduced at the start?**

- A Some emails can feel impolite despite efforts to be polite
- B Most workers no longer use email professionally
- C Rude emails are mainly a problem outside work
- D Email has become less important in modern offices

12 **Why does the opening style of some emails annoy one listener?**

- A It contains too many friendly phrases
- B It includes a long personal introduction
- C It asks for a reply too quickly
- D It feels unnecessarily formal and threatening

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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- 13 **What does the single-emoji example show?**
- A Emojis are always unacceptable at work
 - B A minimal reply can feel disrespectful after a careful message
 - C Carefully written emails are usually unclear
 - D Anonymous messages are more polite than signed ones
- 14 **What does "put someone on the defensive" mean here?**
- A Make someone eager to continue the exchange
 - B Force someone to answer every point in detail
 - C Make someone feel threatened or unsure
 - D Encourage someone to use a warmer greeting
- 15 **How are the two early email examples classified?**
- A As uncivil forms of communication
 - B As formal but acceptable workplace habits
 - C As examples of efficient messaging
 - D As unavoidable technical problems
- 16 **How does Emma Russell distinguish fight and flight responses in emails?**
- A Fight means ignoring emails; flight means copying senior people
 - B Fight means apologising; flight means writing more politely
 - C Fight attacks or dominates; flight withdraws or avoids
 - D Fight happens only to managers; flight happens only to junior staff
- 17 **In the example of a fight response, what does the boss do?**
- A Refuses to answer all points in an email
 - B Deletes the worker's message without reading it
 - C Asks the worker to delay a deadline
 - D Gives someone else credit for the worker's work
- 18 **What does "get work off their plate" refer to?**
- A Finishing every task carefully before replying
 - B Passing tasks or problems to someone else
 - C Refusing to receive emails from colleagues
 - D Organising work into a clearer schedule

- 19 **Why are people more likely to behave uncivilly in email?**
- A They are working in stressful, frazzled environments
 - B They prefer short messages to long ones
 - C They have stopped using workplace greetings altogether
 - D They believe rude emails save money
- 20 **What practical advice is given for writing an angry email?**
- A Copy in senior staff before sending
 - B Reply with an emoji to reduce tension
 - C Pause before pressing send
 - D Avoid answering any of the email's points